

Albert Camus

Albert Camus (/kæˈmuː/ kam-OO^[2] French: [albɛʁ kamy] [ⓘ]; 7 November 1913 – 4 January 1960) was a French philosopher, novelist, author, dramatist, journalist, world federalist,^[3] and political activist. He was the recipient of the 1957 Nobel Prize in Literature at the age of 44, the second-youngest recipient in history, and the first laureate in literature born in Africa. His works include *The Stranger*, *The Plague*, *The Myth of Sisyphus*, *The Fall* and *The Rebel*.

Camus was born in French Algeria to *pied-noir* parents. He spent his childhood in a poor neighbourhood and later studied philosophy at the University of Algiers. He was in Paris when the Germans invaded France during World War II in 1940. Camus tried to flee but finally joined the French Resistance where he served as editor-in-chief at *Combat*, an outlawed newspaper. After the war, he was a celebrity figure and gave many lectures around the world. He married twice but had many extramarital affairs. Camus was politically active; he was part of the left that opposed Joseph Stalin and the Soviet Union because of their totalitarianism. Camus was a moralist and leaned towards anarcho-syndicalism. He was part of many organisations seeking European integration. During the Algerian War (1954–1962), he kept a neutral stance, advocating a multicultural and pluralistic Algeria, a position that was rejected by most parties.

Philosophically, Camus's views contributed to the rise of the philosophy known as absurdism. Some consider Camus's work to show him to be an existentialist, even though he himself firmly rejected the term throughout his lifetime.

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Portrait from *New York World-Telegram and The Sun* Photograph Collection, 1957

Born	7 November 1913 Mondovi, French Algeria
Died	4 January 1960 (aged 46) Villeblevin, France
Spouses	Simone Hié (m. 1934; div. 1936) Francine Faure (m. 1940)
Awards	<u>Nobel Prize in Literature</u> (1957)

Education

Alma mater	<u>University of Algiers</u>
Academic advisor	<u>Jean Grenier</u>

Philosophical work

Region	<u>Western philosophy</u>
School	<u>Continental philosophy</u> <u>Absurdism</u> <u>Existentialism</u> <u>French Nietzscheanism</u>^[1] <u>Syndicalist anarchism</u>